CAN BJP HOLD THE FORT?

THE RULING PARTY SCRAMBLES TO BEAT ANTI-INCUMBENCY IN POLL-BOUND GUJARAT, WHILE THE CONGRESS STRUGGLES TO GET ITS ACT TOGETHER AND AAP HOPES TO DO BETTER

By Kiran D. Tare in Ahmedabad

BJP state president C.R. Patil is ambitious. He is on a mission to surpass the Congress's 1985 record, when the party under Madhavsinh Solanki won 149 out of 182 seats. No party has touched this magic number since—not even under the almost decade and a half of Narendra Modi's rule as chief minister. But the BJP did achieve its highest tally so far under Modi—127 seats in 2002. For Patil and the BJP, Gujarat is a must-win battle as the PM's reputation is at

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BIG PUSH
Gujarat CM Bhupendra Patel, right, and state BJP chief C.R. Patil, left, with Amit Shah at a function in Surat, March 13